

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	14 — India and Her Neighbours
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. A neighbour need not share a land border (Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours); an 'open border' like India–Nepal still IS a border, merely visa-free; and Indian culture spread outward to South-East Asia peacefully through trade, travel and religion, never by conquest. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A textbook lists India's neighbours and places both Sri Lanka and Pakistan in the same single column titled 'land neighbours'. The error in this list is that:

- (A) Pakistan is actually a maritime neighbour and should be moved to the other column
- (B) neither country is a neighbour of India, so both should be deleted
- (C) Sri Lanka shares a long Himalayan land border and is correctly placed
- (D) Sri Lanka shares no land border with India and belongs under maritime neighbours, not land neighbours

2. Which statement best captures why the sea makes a country a neighbour just as a land boundary does?

- (A) A shared sea connects two coasts and lets people, goods and ideas travel between them, so a maritime link is a real neighbourly link
- (B) The sea only separates countries and can never connect them
- (C) Only a fence or wall on land can ever join two countries
- (D) Sea links matter only for countries that have no land neighbours

3. India has both land and maritime neighbours. The single best reason India can have maritime neighbours at all is that:

- (A) India is completely landlocked and surrounded by mountains
- (B) India shares a land border with every island in the world
- (C) the Indian Ocean has no other countries touching it
- (D) India has a long coastline and sits centrally in the Indian Ocean, so other coastal lands lie across the sea from it

4. A student argues, 'Because the Maldives is a tiny group of islands far out in the sea, it cannot count as a neighbour.' The strongest reply is that:

- (A) the Maldives must first build a bridge to India before it counts
- (B) distance and size do not decide neighbourliness; the Maldives shares the Indian Ocean with India and is a close maritime neighbour
- (C) only the largest country in a region can be a neighbour
- (D) the Maldives is actually one of India's land neighbours

5. Of the following, the country that is a neighbour of India through the SEA rather than across a land boundary is:

- (A) Bhutan
- (B) Nepal
- (C) Sri Lanka
- (D) Afghanistan

6. Which pairing of a neighbour with the correct kind of link is right?

- (A) Bangladesh — maritime neighbour; Maldives — land neighbour
- (B) Nepal — maritime neighbour; Sri Lanka — land neighbour
- (C) China — maritime neighbour; Myanmar — island neighbour
- (D) Bangladesh — land neighbour to the east; Maldives — maritime neighbour

7. If you sailed in a straight line south from India's southern tip, the FIRST neighbouring country you would reach is:

- (A) China, which lies to the far north across the Himalayas
- (B) Afghanistan, which lies to the north-west
- (C) Bhutan, the landlocked Himalayan kingdom
- (D) Sri Lanka, lying just across the narrow strait to the south-east

8. The India–Nepal border is often called an 'open border'. The most accurate meaning of this is that:

- (A) there is no border line between the two countries at all
- (B) Nepal is simply a part of India with no separate government
- (C) the border exists and is recognised, but people may cross it freely without a visa or passport
- (D) the border is sealed with a high wall and cannot be crossed

9. Two students debate the India–Nepal border. Aria: 'It is open, so it is not really a border.' Vir: 'It is a border, just one people cross freely.' Who is right, and why?

- (A) Aria, because openness means the two countries are legally one
- (B) Aria, because borders only exist where there are walls
- (C) Vir, because an open border is still a recognised boundary between two sovereign states; only the crossing rules are relaxed
- (D) Neither, because Nepal and India share a maritime border, not a land one

10. Compared with the India–Nepal border, the India–China border in the Himalayas is best described as:

- (A) an open, visa-free border just like the India–Nepal one
- (B) a maritime border running across the Indian Ocean
- (C) a land border too, but one that is not visa-free and is shaped by high mountains
- (D) not a border at all, since mountains separate the two countries

11. The fact that the Himalayas form much of the boundary between India and China best illustrates the idea that:

- (A) natural features of the land, like a great mountain range, can mark the border between countries
- (B) every border in the world is drawn along a coastline
- (C) mountains make any contact between neighbours impossible forever
- (D) geography has nothing to do with where borders lie

12. A neighbour that is reached neither by a shared land border nor purely across open sea, but historically by an OVERLAND route through the mountains to the north-west, is:

- (A) Afghanistan, linked to India by the ancient northern overland route
- (B) the Maldives, reached only across the Indian Ocean
- (C) Sri Lanka, reached only by sailing south
- (D) Indonesia, reached far across the eastern seas

13. Myanmar is called India's 'gateway to South-East Asia' chiefly because it:

- (A) is an island lying far out in the Pacific Ocean
- (B) lies on India's eastern land border and links India by land toward the South-East Asian countries
- (C) blocks all land contact between India and South-East Asia
- (D) shares no border with India and lies across the sea

14. A claim says, 'Nepal is landlocked, so it has no use for the sea.' The best refutation is that:

- (A) Nepal has a long ocean coastline of its own
- (B) landlocked countries never trade with anyone abroad
- (C) even landlocked Nepal needs the sea for trade, and its goods usually reach the ocean through Indian ports
- (D) Nepal reaches the sea through Chinese ports across the high Himalayas only

15. Both Nepal and Bhutan share the same key geographic feature that shapes their economies. That feature is that they are:

- (A) island nations dotted across the Indian Ocean
- (B) landlocked Himalayan countries with no coastline, depending on India for access to the sea
- (C) long-coastline maritime neighbours of India
- (D) desert countries with no mountains at all

16. Bhutan generates much of its electricity from fast-flowing Himalayan rivers. This is possible mainly because Bhutan:

- (A) is a mountainous country where water falling from a height can turn turbines (hydroelectricity)
- (B) has a flat coastline ideal for tidal power
- (C) imports all its electricity from distant oceans
- (D) burns sea water to make power

17. Bhutan measures progress through 'Gross National Happiness' rather than money alone. Compared with a country that judges success only by wealth, Bhutan's approach gives extra weight to:

- (A) the size of its army and its number of weapons
- (B) the total number of islands it controls
- (C) the wellbeing of people, care for the environment, good governance and culture
- (D) how many tall city skyscrapers it can build

18. A landlocked neighbour and a maritime neighbour differ most clearly in that:

- (A) the landlocked one has the longer coastline of the two
- (B) the landlocked one has no coast and must borrow a sea route, while the maritime one is itself reached across the sea
- (C) the maritime one can never trade by sea
- (D) both have identical access to the ocean

19. Which reasoning correctly explains why landlocked Nepal and Bhutan still benefit from India's coastline?

- (A) India's coastline gives Nepal and Bhutan their own beaches
- (B) the coastline lets the two countries become islands
- (C) a coastline is useless to any country that does not own it
- (D) their overseas goods can pass through Indian ports, so India serves as their gateway to the sea

20. Compare Pakistan and China as India's neighbours. The shared truth about BOTH is that they:

- (A) share a land border with India
- (B) are both maritime neighbours reached only by sea

- (C) are both landlocked countries with no coastline
- (D) share an open, visa-free border like Nepal's

21. The phrase used for India and Pakistan, 'a shared heritage but a divided history', means that the two countries:

- (A) have absolutely nothing in common in culture or past
- (B) are today a single country with one government
- (C) were never connected at any point in the past
- (D) grew from common cultural roots yet were separated into different nations

22. Which comparison of Sri Lanka and the Maldives is most accurate?

- (A) both are landlocked Himalayan neighbours of India
- (B) Sri Lanka is an archipelago while the Maldives is a single mountain
- (C) both are maritime neighbours, but the Maldives is an archipelago of many small islands while Sri Lanka is a single large island
- (D) both share a long land border with India

23. Among India's neighbours, the one most accurately described as a 'newborn neighbour' that became a separate nation relatively recently is:

- (A) China, one of the world's oldest states
- (B) Nepal, an ancient Himalayan kingdom
- (C) Bangladesh
- (D) Sri Lanka, an old island civilisation

24. Consider two neighbours: Afghanistan and the Maldives. The key difference in HOW each has historically connected with India is that:

- (A) Afghanistan links across the sea while the Maldives links overland
- (B) both linked only through the Himalayas to the north
- (C) both linked only across the Indian Ocean to the south
- (D) Afghanistan linked to India by overland routes through the north-west, while the Maldives links across the sea

25. A list of India's land neighbours to the WEST and NORTH-WEST would correctly include:

- (A) Sri Lanka and the Maldives
- (B) Pakistan and Afghanistan
- (C) Myanmar and Bangladesh
- (D) Bhutan and Nepal

26. Which of India's neighbours lies to the EAST, sharing a long land border and many transboundary rivers with India?

- (A) Afghanistan, lying to the north-west
- (B) Bangladesh
- (C) the Maldives, lying to the south-west across the sea
- (D) Pakistan, lying to the west

27. A 'transboundary river' shared by India and Bangladesh creates a need for the two countries to:

- (A) build dams to stop the river crossing the border entirely
- (B) pretend the river does not flow between them
- (C) stop speaking to each other about the river forever
- (D) cooperate on how the shared waters are used and managed

28. The Ganga and the Brahmaputra both flow from India into Bangladesh before reaching the sea. The best lesson this teaches about neighbours is that:

- (A) rivers ignore political borders, so upstream and downstream neighbours are tied together and must manage water jointly
- (B) rivers stop flowing the moment they reach a border
- (C) each country can use a shared river without affecting the other
- (D) borders completely separate the two countries' water supplies

29. Which statement about the Himalayas as a shared geographic feature is most accurate?

- (A) the Himalayas lie wholly within India and touch no neighbour
- (B) the Himalayas are a desert that blocks all rivers
- (C) the Himalayas are shared by several neighbours and feed great rivers that flow into India and beyond
- (D) the Himalayas are a maritime feature out in the Indian Ocean

30. That India shares both the Himalayas and major rivers with several neighbours shows that the neighbourhood is bound together by:

- (A) a single shared government over all the countries
- (B) one common currency used by every neighbour
- (C) borders that keep each country's geography fully separate
- (D) a common physical geography that crosses political borders

31. A river beginning in the Himalayas, flowing through India, and emptying into the sea after passing into Bangladesh best illustrates the concept of a:

- (A) landlocked lake with no outlet to the sea
- (B) strait separating two large landmasses
- (C) river that flows entirely within one country
- (D) transboundary river crossing the borders of more than one country

32. Why does shared geography often push neighbours toward cooperation rather than conflict?

- (A) shared geography means one country can fully control everyone's resources
- (B) features like rivers and mountains span borders, so managing them well requires neighbours to work together
- (C) shared rivers and ranges belong to no country, so no one need discuss them
- (D) geography is purely decorative and has no practical effect on neighbours

33. Among India's neighbours, the country whose territory lies largely 'in the lap of the Himalayas' and has no coastline is:

- (A) Nepal
- (B) Sri Lanka, a southern island
- (C) the Maldives, a chain of low islands
- (D) Bangladesh, a low-lying delta by the sea

34. The shared use of Himalayan-fed rivers by India and its northern and eastern neighbours best supports the conclusion that:

- (A) each country's rivers are entirely its own and affect no one else
- (B) the rivers vanish at every international border
- (C) neighbours' fortunes are linked by the same waters, making cooperation over rivers a regional necessity
- (D) water is too unimportant for neighbours to ever discuss

35. Thai kings have taken the name 'Rama' and an old Thai capital was called 'Ayutthaya', echoing Ayodhya. The best explanation is that:

- (A) India conquered Thailand and forced these names upon it
- (B) Thailand once ruled over India and copied the names back
- (C) Indian culture and stories like the Ramayana spread peacefully to Thailand through trade, travel and religion
- (D) the resemblance is pure coincidence with no real connection

36. A claim states, 'India became influential in Indonesia and Cambodia because it conquered them with armies.' The best correction is that:

- (A) yes, large Indian armies marched in and ruled these lands
- (B) the influence appeared only in the last few decades
- (C) those lands show no traces of Indian culture at all
- (D) Indian culture spread there mainly through trade, travel and religion, not by military conquest

37. The great temple complex of Angkor Wat in Cambodia, with its Hindu themes, is best understood as evidence that:

- (A) India physically built the temple as a colony it ruled
- (B) Indian religion and art spread across the seas to South-East Asia and were adapted there
- (C) Cambodia had no contact with India at any time
- (D) the temple was carried piece by piece from India by ship

38. Thailand's 'Ramakien' is best described as:

- (A) an exact, unchanged copy of the Indian Ramayana
- (B) Thailand's own retelling of the Ramayana, shaped by Thai culture
- (C) a Thai trade route to India
- (D) one of the three schools of Buddhism

39. The Borobudur monument, often cited as evidence of Indian cultural influence abroad, is located in:

- (A) Bhutan
- (B) Indonesia
- (C) Afghanistan
- (D) the Maldives

40. What is the single most important difference between how Indian culture reached Afghanistan and how it reached Indonesia?

- (A) it reached Afghanistan largely by overland routes and Indonesia largely across the seas
- (B) it reached both only by conquest and warfare
- (C) it reached Afghanistan by sea and Indonesia by land
- (D) it reached neither and both developed in total isolation

41. The spread of Indian religion and art to many neighbours, without conquest, best shows that India acted as:

- (A) a source of ideas, faith and culture shared peacefully across the region
- (B) a conqueror that ruled the whole region by force
- (C) a country that only borrowed culture and gave nothing
- (D) a land cut off from all contact with its neighbours

42. The ancient Indian name 'Suvarnabhumi' (Golden Land) for parts of South-East Asia, together with Indian-style temples there, best supports the conclusion that:

- (A) South-East Asia was unknown to ancient Indians
- (B) the temples were built by Indian colonial armies
- (C) the name proves India physically owned the region
- (D) Indians knew of and exchanged culture with South-East Asia long ago through sea trade

43. Buddhism spread from India to its neighbours in several great schools. This outward spread of a faith born in India shows that India was:

- (A) a country that imported Buddhism from a distant continent
- (B) a place where ideas originated and then travelled outward to other lands
- (C) completely sealed off from its neighbours
- (D) unwilling to share any culture beyond its borders

44. Which statement best distinguishes how Indian culture relates to Sri Lanka versus to a far South-East Asian land like Indonesia?

- (A) Sri Lanka received Indian influence but Indonesia had none
- (B) Indonesia received it but Sri Lanka had none
- (C) both received strong Indian cultural and religious influence, Sri Lanka as a near maritime neighbour and Indonesia across longer sea routes
- (D) neither received any Indian cultural influence

- 45.** SAARC, the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, was created mainly to:
- (A) promote cooperation and shared progress among the countries of South Asia
 - (B) help one country conquer the others in the region
 - (C) end all trade between the South Asian countries
 - (D) replace each member country's own government
- 46.** SAARC bringing together several South Asian countries is best understood as an example of:
- (A) the merging of all members into one single nation
 - (B) each country cutting all ties with its neighbours
 - (C) regionalism — neighbours working together for peace, stability and shared progress
 - (D) one nation ruling all the others by force
- 47.** Why might small neighbours like the Maldives still matter greatly to India within a body like SAARC?
- (A) regional security and friendship depend on every member, so even small island neighbours count
 - (B) only the largest member's views matter, so small ones can be ignored
 - (C) small countries have nothing to offer the region
 - (D) small island countries cannot really be members at all
- 48.** A 'bilateral' agreement between India and a neighbour is one made:
- (A) among all the countries of the world at once
 - (B) between the two countries — the two sides involved
 - (C) within a single country only, with no neighbour
 - (D) between a country and the open sea
- 49.** Cooperation among neighbours over a shared river is best handled by which kind of arrangement?
- (A) agreements between the countries that share the river, so each side's needs are considered
 - (B) one country deciding alone and ignoring the others
 - (C) leaving the river entirely unmanaged by anyone
 - (D) letting a distant continent decide for the region
- 50.** The 'Uttarapatha' is best described as:
- (A) the ancient northern overland trade route linking the Ganga plains toward Central Asia through the north-west
 - (B) a southern sea route to Sri Lanka
 - (C) one of the three great schools of Buddhism
 - (D) a single high Himalayan mountain peak
- 51.** The Uttarapatha and the Dakshinapatha were respectively the ancient:

- (A) two great schools of Buddhism (B) two seasonal cropping cycles
- (C) two maritime island neighbours
- (D) northern and southern overland trade routes of India

52. The Silk Route and the old spice routes mattered for India's neighbourhood because they:

- (A) carried goods, ideas and culture back and forth between regions
- (B) sealed India off completely from every other land
- (C) moved only soldiers and never any goods (D) came into being only in modern times

53. That India was linked to its neighbours by routes like the Uttarapatha and the spice routes long ago best shows that India's regional ties are:

- (A) very old, built up over many centuries of trade and exchange
- (B) brand-new, formed only in the twenty-first century
- (C) purely military, based only on armies
- (D) based entirely on conquest and never on trade

54. A 'diaspora' connecting India with its neighbours refers to:

- (A) a narrow channel of sea between two coasts
- (B) communities of people who have spread out and settled far from their original homeland
- (C) a chain of small islands in the ocean (D) one of the great schools of Buddhism

55. Iran and Oman are best described in this chapter as India's:

- (A) eastern island neighbours across the Pacific
- (B) landlocked Himalayan neighbours to the north
- (C) ancient western neighbours, linked to India by sea and old trade
- (D) Arctic neighbours far to the north

56. Assertion (A): Sri Lanka is one of India's neighbours. Reason (R): A country must share a land border to be a neighbour. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (B) A is false and R is true (C) Both A and R are false
- (D) A is true but R is false; Sri Lanka is a neighbour through the sea, and a land border is not required

57. Assertion (A): The India–Nepal open border still counts as a real border. Reason (R): An open border is one where people cross without a visa, yet the boundary between the two sovereign states remains. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (B) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (C) A is true but R is false (D) A is false but R is true

58. Assertion (A): Indian culture is found in Thailand and Cambodia. Reason (R): India conquered these lands and forced its culture on them. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) A is true but R is false; the culture spread peacefully through trade, travel and religion, not conquest
- (D) Both A and R are false

59. Assertion (A): Landlocked Nepal still depends on the sea. Reason (R): Nepal's overseas goods usually travel through Indian ports to reach the ocean. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A

60. A student writes: 'The Maldives is too small to be a neighbour, Nepal's open border means it is part of India, and Indians learned Buddhism from Indonesia.' How many of these three statements are correct?

- (A) Exactly one is correct
- (B) None of the three is correct
- (C) Exactly two are correct
- (D) All three are correct

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	A	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	C	32	B	42	D	52	A
3	D	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	C	44	C	54	B
5	C	15	B	25	B	35	C	45	A	55	C
6	D	16	A	26	B	36	D	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	D	37	B	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	A	38	B	48	B	58	C
9	C	19	D	29	C	39	B	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	A	30	D	40	A	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) A land neighbour shares a land boundary; Sri Lanka is separated from India by the sea (the Palk Strait), so it is a maritime neighbour and is mis-filed. Pakistan does share a land border, so it is correctly a land neighbour and need not move. The claim that neither is a neighbour ignores that both are close neighbours. Sri Lanka has no Himalayan border at all.

2. (A) The chapter treats maritime neighbours as genuine neighbours because a shared sea has long carried trade, travel and culture between coasts. Saying the sea only separates ignores centuries of sea-borne exchange. A land wall is not the only way to be joined. Sea links matter regardless of whether a country also has land neighbours.

3. (D) Maritime neighbours exist because India's long coast faces the Indian Ocean, with lands like Sri Lanka and the Maldives across the water. India is not landlocked; it has an extensive coastline. It does not share land borders with islands. The Indian Ocean is rimmed by many countries, which is precisely why India has maritime neighbours.

- 4. (B)** Neighbourliness rests on a shared sea or border, not on a country's size or exact distance, so the small Maldives is still a maritime neighbour. No bridge is needed for a maritime link. There is no rule that only large countries qualify. The Maldives has no land border with India, so it is maritime, not land.
- 5. (C)** Sri Lanka is separated from India by the Palk Strait and is a maritime neighbour. Bhutan and Nepal are landlocked Himalayan neighbours joined by land. Afghanistan is linked to India historically by overland routes, not by sea.
- 6. (D)** Bangladesh shares a long land border with India and the Maldives is reached only across the sea, so this pairing is correct. Bangladesh is land, not maritime, and the Maldives is maritime, not land. Nepal is landlocked and Sri Lanka is across the sea, so that pairing is reversed. China is a land neighbour across the Himalayas and Myanmar is a land neighbour, not an island.
- 7. (D)** Sri Lanka sits just off India's southern tip, across a narrow strait, so it is the nearest land you would reach by sailing south. China lies to the north beyond the Himalayas, the opposite direction. Afghanistan is to the north-west by land. Bhutan is landlocked in the northern Himalayas, unreachable by sailing south.
- 8. (C)** An open border is a real, agreed boundary that people may cross without visas — open in access, not absent. Saying there is no border confuses 'open' with 'non-existent'. Nepal is a separate sovereign country, not part of India. An open border is the opposite of a sealed wall.
- 9. (C)** An open border keeps the legal line between two nations while easing crossing, so Vir is right. Openness does not merge the two states. Borders exist by agreement, not only where walls stand. India and Nepal share a land border, not a maritime one.
- 10. (C)** Both are land borders, but the India–China boundary is not the open, visa-free kind that India–Nepal is, and it runs through the high Himalayas. It is not visa-free like Nepal's. It is on land, not across the ocean. A mountain range marks a border rather than removing it.
- 11. (A)** A boundary following a mountain range shows geography shaping borders. Not every border is coastal; many follow rivers or mountains. Mountains hinder but never wholly prevent contact, as old passes and trade show. The example directly contradicts the idea that geography is irrelevant to borders.
- 12. (A)** Afghanistan was tied to India by the old northern overland route, the Uttarapatha, through the north-west. The Maldives and Sri Lanka are reached across the sea, not overland. Indonesia lies far across the eastern seas, a maritime link, not an overland one.
- 13. (B)** Myanmar's position on India's eastern land border makes it the overland doorway toward South-East Asia. It is not a Pacific island. As a gateway it opens, rather than blocks,

land contact. It does share a land border with India, so it is not a sea-only neighbour.

14. (C) A landlocked country still depends on the sea for overseas trade and routes its goods through a neighbour's ports — for Nepal, mainly India's. Nepal has no coast of its own. Landlocked countries do trade abroad; they simply borrow a route to the sea. The far easier and main gateway for Nepal is Indian ports, not crossing the high Himalayas to the north.

15. (B) Nepal and Bhutan are both landlocked Himalayan states without coastlines, relying on India to reach the sea. Neither is an island nation. Neither has a coastline, so they are not maritime neighbours. They are mountainous, not desert, lands.

16. (A) Steep mountain rivers give the falling water needed for hydroelectricity, which suits Bhutan's terrain. It is landlocked, so it has no coastline for tidal power. It produces, not merely imports, power. Burning sea water is not a real source of electricity.

17. (C) Gross National Happiness counts wellbeing, environment, governance and culture beyond pure income. It is not a measure of military strength. Bhutan, being landlocked, has no islands to count. It is not a measure of skyscrapers either.

18. (B) A landlocked country has no coastline and depends on a neighbour for sea access, whereas a maritime neighbour is a coastal land reached over the sea. A landlocked country has no coastline at all, let alone a longer one. A maritime neighbour trades by sea by definition. Their sea access is plainly different, not identical.

19. (D) India's ports act as transit points so landlocked neighbours can ship goods overseas — India is their sea gateway. The coast does not give them beaches of their own. A coastline cannot turn an inland country into islands. A neighbour's coast is far from useless; it provides the sea access landlocked states lack.

20. (A) Both Pakistan and China have land boundaries with India. Neither is a sea-only neighbour. Pakistan in fact has a coastline, so 'both landlocked' is false. Neither shares the visa-free open arrangement that marks the India–Nepal border.

21. (D) The phrase points to deep common roots alongside a later political separation into distinct nations. It is not a claim of having nothing in common. They are not one country today. And they were closely connected historically, not unconnected.

22. (C) Both are reached across the sea, yet they differ in form: the Maldives is a chain of small islands and Sri Lanka is one big island. Neither is landlocked or Himalayan. The description is the reverse of calling Sri Lanka the archipelago. Neither shares a land border with India.

23. (C) Bangladesh emerged as a separate nation comparatively recently, earning the 'newborn neighbour' description. China is a very old continuing state. Nepal is a long-

standing Himalayan kingdom. Sri Lanka has an ancient civilisation. None of the latter three fits 'newborn'.

24. (D) Afghanistan's ties ran along old overland routes to the north-west, whereas the Maldives, a sea-girt archipelago, links by sea. The statement that reverses these is wrong. Neither connects through the northern Himalayas as a pair. They do not both connect by the southern ocean — only the Maldives does.

25. (B) Pakistan lies to India's west and Afghanistan to the north-west, both historically land-linked. Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours to the south. Myanmar and Bangladesh lie to the east. Bhutan and Nepal lie along the northern Himalayas, not the west.

26. (B) Bangladesh lies to India's east, sharing a long land border and rivers that flow across the boundary. Afghanistan is to the north-west. The Maldives is a maritime neighbour to the south-west. Pakistan lies to the west. Only Bangladesh fits the eastern, river-sharing description.

27. (D) Because a transboundary river serves both countries, sharing it sensibly calls for cooperation over its waters. Stopping the flow with dams would harm the downstream country and breed conflict, not solve it. Ignoring the river does not make the shared dependence vanish. Refusing to talk worsens, rather than manages, a shared resource.

28. (A) A river crossing a border binds upstream and downstream neighbours, so joint management makes sense. Rivers do not halt at borders; that is why they are called transboundary. What one country does upstream affects the other downstream, so use is not independent. Shared rivers connect, rather than separate, water supplies.

29. (C) The Himalayan range stretches across several countries and is the source of major rivers feeding the region. It is not wholly within India; Nepal, Bhutan and others share it. It is a snow-fed mountain system, not a desert, and it gives birth to rivers rather than blocking them. It is a land feature, not a maritime one.

30. (D) Shared mountains and rivers mean the region's physical geography spills across borders, linking the countries. There is no single government over them; each is sovereign. They do not share one currency. The very fact that geography is shared shows borders do not fully separate it.

31. (D) A river that flows across one or more borders on its way to the sea is transboundary. It is not a closed landlocked lake. A strait is a narrow sea channel, not a river. By definition it does not stay within one country.

32. (B) Because rivers and ranges straddle borders, sensible management needs joint effort, encouraging cooperation. No single country can fully control a feature shared with

others. Shared resources demand more discussion, not less. Geography has very practical effects, such as on water and trade.

33. (A) Nepal nestles in the Himalayas and is landlocked, with no coastline. Sri Lanka is a southern island with a coast. The Maldives is a low island chain in the sea. Bangladesh is a delta country with a coastline. Only Nepal fits the Himalayan, coastless description.

34. (C) Common rivers tie neighbours' water security together, so cooperation is a practical necessity. The rivers are shared, not entirely each country's own. They cross borders rather than vanishing at them. Water is among the most important shared concerns, not unimportant.

35. (C) The echoes of Indian names reflect cultural influence carried peacefully by traders, travellers and teachers. There was no Indian conquest of Thailand. Thailand did not rule India. The pattern of names and epics is too consistent to be coincidence.

36. (D) Indian ideas, religion and art travelled to South-East Asia by peaceful exchange, not conquest. There were no large conquering Indian armies in these lands. The influence is ancient, not recent. Monuments and stories show clear traces, so denying any influence is false.

37. (B) Angkor Wat shows Indian religious and artistic ideas taking root and being adapted in South-East Asia. India did not rule Cambodia as a colony to build it. Far from having no contact, Cambodia absorbed strong Indian influence. The temple was built locally, not shipped from India.

38. (B) The Ramakien is a distinctly Thai version of the Ramayana, adapted to local culture. It is not an unchanged copy. It is an epic, not a trade route. It is a story, not a Buddhist school.

39. (B) Borobudur, a vast Buddhist monument reflecting Indian influence, stands in Indonesia. It is not in Bhutan, Afghanistan or the Maldives. Its location across the eastern seas shows Indian culture spreading by maritime contact.

40. (A) Overland routes carried Indian influence north-west to Afghanistan, while sea routes carried it to island Indonesia. Neither spread by conquest. The directions are not reversed — Afghanistan is overland, Indonesia maritime. Both clearly received Indian influence, so neither was isolated.

41. (A) India was a fountain of ideas, religion and art that travelled outward by peaceful exchange. It did not rule the region by force. It gave culture outward rather than only borrowing. Such wide influence proves it was richly connected, not cut off.

42. (D) An Indian name for the region plus shared temple styles shows long-standing maritime exchange and knowledge of South-East Asia. Far from unknown, the area had an

Indian name. The temples reflect influence, not colonial conquest. A place-name does not amount to ownership.

43. (B) Buddhism arose in India and then spread outward, so India was a source of ideas for others. It did not import Buddhism from afar; the faith began there. Such spread shows openness, not sealing-off. Sharing culture so widely contradicts any unwillingness to share.

44. (C) Indian religion and culture reached both, Sri Lanka being a close maritime neighbour and Indonesia lying across longer sea routes. It is wrong to deny influence to either, and equally wrong to deny it to both. The shared thread is peaceful maritime cultural exchange in both directions of distance.

45. (A) SAARC exists to foster cooperation and joint progress among South Asian nations. It is not a tool of conquest. It aims to encourage, not end, regional trade and contact. It does not replace member governments; each stays sovereign.

46. (C) SAARC embodies regionalism, the idea of neighbours cooperating for common good. The members do not merge into one nation; they remain separate. The aim is more ties, not cutting them. It is cooperation among equals, not rule by force.

47. (A) Regional peace and security rest on cooperation with every neighbour, so even a small island state matters. Size does not erase a member's importance. Small countries contribute to trade, security and friendship. Small island states are full neighbours and can take part.

48. (B) 'Bilateral' means involving two sides, so it is an agreement between two countries. An agreement among all nations would be multilateral or global, not bilateral. An internal arrangement involves no neighbour, so it is not bilateral. A country cannot make an agreement with the sea.

49. (A) A shared river is best managed by agreements among the sharing countries, balancing each side's needs. One country deciding alone breeds conflict over a shared resource. Leaving it unmanaged risks disputes and waste. A distant continent has no stake or standing to decide a local river.

50. (A) The Uttarapatha was the great northern overland trade route running toward Central Asia via the north-west. It was overland in the north, not a southern sea route. It was a trade route, not a Buddhist school. It was a route, not a single peak.

51. (D) Uttarapatha was the northern route and Dakshinapatha the southern, both overland trade routes. They were routes, not Buddhist schools. They were not cropping seasons. They were land routes, not island neighbours.

52. (A) These routes were channels for goods, ideas and culture flowing between regions, knitting neighbours together. They opened India to exchange rather than sealing it off.

They carried trade goods, not only soldiers. They are ancient, not modern, networks.

53. (A) Ancient trade routes prove India's neighbourly ties are centuries old. They are not a recent twenty-first-century creation. The routes carried trade and culture, not just armies. The links grew through trade and exchange, not conquest.

54. (B) A diaspora is people who have moved and settled away from their homeland, forming links between countries. A narrow sea channel is a strait, not a diaspora. A chain of islands is an archipelago. A school of Buddhism is a religious tradition, not a community abroad.

55. (C) Iran and Oman lie to India's west and have long been linked by sea trade. They are not eastern Pacific islands. They are not landlocked Himalayan states. They are nowhere near the Arctic. They belong to India's wider western, sea-linked neighbourhood.

56. (D) Sri Lanka really is a neighbour (A true), but the reason is wrong because a maritime link also makes a neighbour, so no land border is required (R false). R does not explain A. A is not false; Sri Lanka is a neighbour. Both being false is wrong because A is true.

57. (B) The open border is a real border (A true), precisely because openness relaxes crossing while the sovereign boundary stays (R true and explanatory). R does explain A, so the 'does not explain' option is wrong. R is true, not false. A is true, not false.

58. (C) Indian culture is indeed present in Thailand and Cambodia (A true), but the reason is wrong because it spread by peaceful exchange, not conquest (R false). R cannot explain A. A is not false; the influence is real. Both being false is wrong since A is true.

59. (D) Nepal depends on the sea for overseas trade (A true), and the reason explains why: its goods reach the ocean via Indian ports (R true and explanatory). R does explain A. R is true, not false. A is true, not false, since landlocked Nepal still needs sea access.

60. (B) All three are wrong: a country's small size does not stop it being a maritime neighbour; an open border keeps Nepal a separate sovereign nation rather than part of India; and Buddhism arose in India and spread outward to lands like Indonesia, not the reverse. Since every statement fails, none is correct, so 'one', 'two' and 'all three' are all wrong.